

Annual Town Meeting was called to order at the Leverett Elementary School by Moderator, Larry Farber, at 9:11 am. The Annual Report was dedicated to Julie Shively and Ken Kahn, Planning Board member for 35 years, was thanked for his service. Other announcements were moved to the end of the meeting because the Moderator needed to leave at 12:30.

Article One: To choose all necessary Town officers to serve for periods prescribed by law or Town bylaw, or take any action relative thereto.

Larry explained the process for nominating from the floor.

There were no contested elections. Newly elected officers:

Assessors: Cat Ford, 3-year term;

Board of Health: Lizzie Alwan, 3-year term and Cynthia Baldwin, 3-year term;

Library Trustees: Chris Condit and Joan Godsey, 3-year terms;

Constable: John Swartz, 3-year term;

Finance Committee: Jed Proujanksy and Isaiah Robison, 3-year terms;

Planning Board: Molly Daniel, 5-year term;

School Committee: Ann Elise Olson, 3-year term;

Select Board: Tom Hankinson, 3-year term.

Article Two: To see if the Town will amend Section VI of the Amherst Pelham Regional School District Agreement by replacing subsection j) as follows: "For Fiscal Year 2024 only, the alternative operating budget assessment shall be calculated as a five-year average of minimum contributions with the remainder of the assessment allocated to the member towns in accordance with the per-pupil method found in Section VI e) of the Amherst Pelham Regional School District Agreement. Additionally, if any member town's assessment based on this method increases or decreases more than 4% from their Fiscal Year 2023 assessment, the Fiscal Year 2024 assessment shall be limited to a 4% change provided that the requirements of Minimum Local Contribution are still met. The five-year average of minimum contributions will include the five most recent years."; or take any action relative thereto.

Article Two: (___TOM___) I move that the Town vote to amend Section VI of the Amherst Pelham Regional School District Agreement by replacing subsection j) as follows: "For Fiscal Year 2024 only, the alternative operating budget assessment shall be calculated as a five-year average of minimum contributions with the remainder of the assessment allocated to the member towns in accordance with the per-pupil method found in Section VI e) of the Amherst Pelham Regional School District Agreement. Additionally, if any member town's assessment based on this method increases or decreases more than 4% from their Fiscal Year 2023 assessment, the Fiscal Year 2024 assessment shall be limited to a 4% change provided that the requirements of Minimum Local Contribution are still met. The five-year average of minimum contributions will include the five most recent years."

Seconded.

Mike Morris and Doug Slaughter from the Regional School answered questions. Carries unanimously.

Article Three: To see if the Town will vote to raise and appropriate or transfer from available funds such sums of money as shall be necessary to meet Town expenses, or take any action relative thereto.

Article Three: (___MELISSA___) I move that the Town vote to raise and appropriate such sums of money as shall be ne

cessary to meet the Town's operating budget for the ensuing fiscal year.

Seconded.

Moderator explains process. All budget line items are approved except Fire Department which is held for more discussion. After discussion Fire Department budget also carries.

Article Four: To see if the Town will vote to set the salaries of elected officials as provided by MGL Chapter 41, Section 108, to be made effective from July 1, 2023 as presented in the budget, or take any action relative thereto.

Article Four: (PAT) I move that the Town vote to set the salaries of elected officials as provided by MGL Chapter 41, Section 108, to be made effective from July 1, 2023 as presented in the budget.

Seconded, carries unanimously.

Article Five: To see if the Town will vote to transfer the sum of \$140,000 from the Stabilization Account to repave the parking areas near and around the Public Safety Complex and the Library, or take any action relative thereto.

Seconded, carries unanimously.

Article Six: To see if the Town will vote to transfer the sum of \$86,000 from the Stabilization Account to purchase and equip a new or used brush truck for the Fire Department, or take any action relative thereto.

Article Six: (MELISSA) I move that the Town vote to transfer the sum of \$86,000 from the Stabilization Account to purchase and equip a new or used brush truck for the Fire Department.

Seconded, carries unanimously.

Article Seven: To see if the Town will vote to transfer the sum of \$39,000 from the Stabilization Account to purchase and equip a new exhaust system for the Fire Department truck bays, or take any action relative thereto.

Article Seven: (PAT) I move that the Town vote to transfer the sum of \$39,000 from the Stabilization Account to purchase and equip a new exhaust system for the Fire Department truck bays.

Seconded, carries unanimously.

Article Eight: To see if the Town will vote to transfer the sum of \$2,359 from the Free Cash Account for a new fire alarm system at the Leverett Library, or take any action relative thereto.

Article Eight: (TOM) I move that the Town vote to transfer the sum of \$2,359 from the Free Cash Account for a new fire alarm system at the Leverett Library.